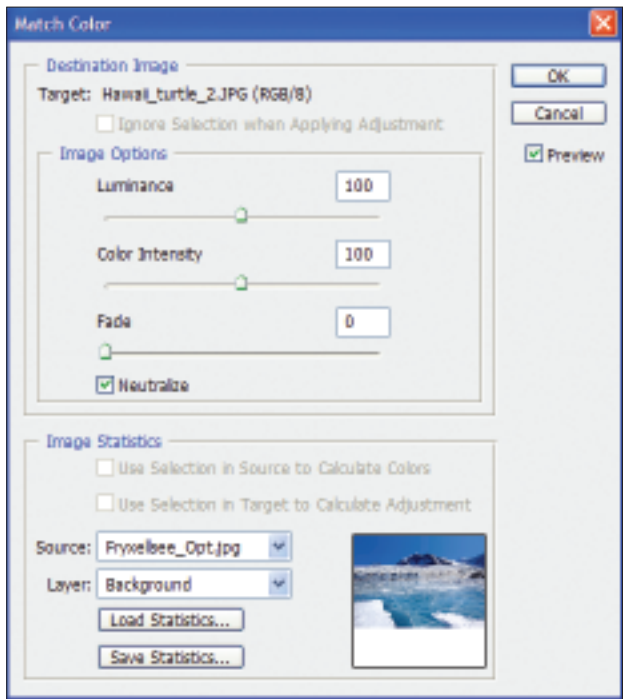


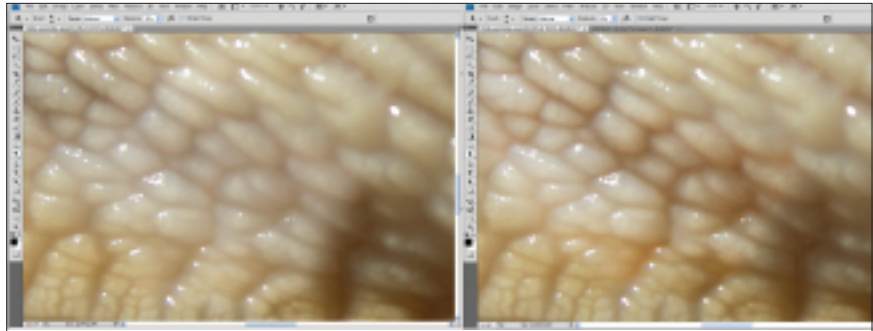


Matching colours to another image

reference picture. Remember the file name. Go to Image > Adjustments > Match Color. Under Image Statistics, under “source” select the file name of your reference image. Your image should immediately change the colour set. The image options that you see at this point of time, are absolutes and have nothing to do with the reference image. Before you do this make sure that the files you are working on are set to the same colour space. This means that the checkmarks in Image > Mode should be consistent (this is also shown next to the filename in the tab for the file).

Protecting the tone of the image while dodging and burning.

Until the release of CS3, dodging and burning an image always looked unnatural because of the way the image grayed or darkened upon application.



The old dodge tool (left) and the new dodge tool (right), that preserves tones

The new burning and dodging tools have an option known as “Protect Tones” which better preserve the colour information of the image. The picture on the left shows dodging without the Protect Tones feature, while the one on the right shows dodging with the Protect Tones feature turned on. The difference is noticeable, but there is no standard approach for using this feature as the usage is dependent on the kind of image and the desired output.

Increase or re-allocate the

scratch-disk space

Photoshop uses its own virtual memory when it runs short of the system’s virtual memory and the RAM. Usually, the scratch-disk space is used from the same drive that Photoshop is installed on. As this is usually the C: drive, where the Windows virtual memory is also housed, this location is not ideal. Go to Edit > Preferences > Scratch Disks to change this location. The window just lists the drives available, and the amount of free space on each. Just make sure you check the drives that have a lot of free space on them.

Enable Open GL

Photoshop CS4 can now use Open GL for smoother operations and some file effects. This has been included specifically for their support for 3D files, but it also helps in the overall user interface experience. To enable Open GL, go

to Edit > Preferences > Performance and check Enable Open GL.

Further tweaks to optimise the memory usage

The undo history of CS4 takes up a lot of space. Go to Edit > Preferences > Performance, and reduce the steps of undo operations to keep in memory. The cache levels can be increased upto 8, or decreased as per individual preferences. After a series of complicated operations are finished, you can clear the memory used by Photoshop by going to Edit > Purge and selecting an option. The options available are Undo, Clipboard, Histories and All.

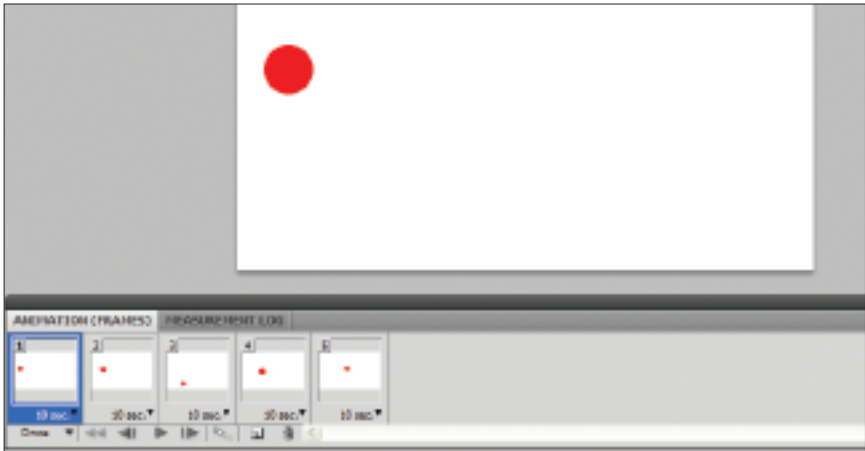
Create a Panorama

If you have a set of pictures you would like to be merged into a Panorama, doing so is an easy process on CS4. The merging is visibly better than CS3. Wires, foliage and seascapes are handled better. Go to File > Automate > Photomerge, choose the auto perspective, add the images from your system in order. To do this, click on the Browse button, and select the files that you want to be merged into a panorama. If you have already opened the files in photoshop (for editing), then simply click on Add Open Files. Click on OK and sit back and watch Photoshop do its magic. This will take some time, and you will see windows open and close repeatedly, but do not worry.

Simple animation using Photoshop

You can use Photoshop to animate objects and layers in a picture, and then export it as a GIF. This was possible in previous versions of Photoshop as well, but CS4 provides users with tweening options and further controls. To create a simple animation, of say, a ball bouncing, create a white background with a circle shape to represent a ball. Then, go to Window > Animation > Frame View. Select the first frame, and click on the Duplicate Frame button (right before the trash can). Duplicate the frame five times, for different key positions of the ball. Select individual frames, and drag the shape to the relevant position to do this.

Now select two consecutive frames, go to the animation window and select tween. You will see a window with



Animation using Photoshop

options to change parameters. The available options are Position, Opacity and Effects. Position is the only parameter that used in this particular animation, although you can use others. For example, you can change the opacity, so that the ball becomes invisible when it bounces, and so on. For now, input the number of frames to add as five. Now repeat the procedure for the consecutive original frames. Select all the frames, and click on Play to preview the animation.

Export individual layers as files

Photoshop lets you export individual layers of the file you are currently working on, into separate files. The files generated are saved in the same folder, and automatically named. You can choose naming, compression and file type options. File > Scripts > Export Layers to Files. Tweak the options here as per your preference. Check Visible layers if you want to export just the visible layers. Then click on Run.

Working with snapshots

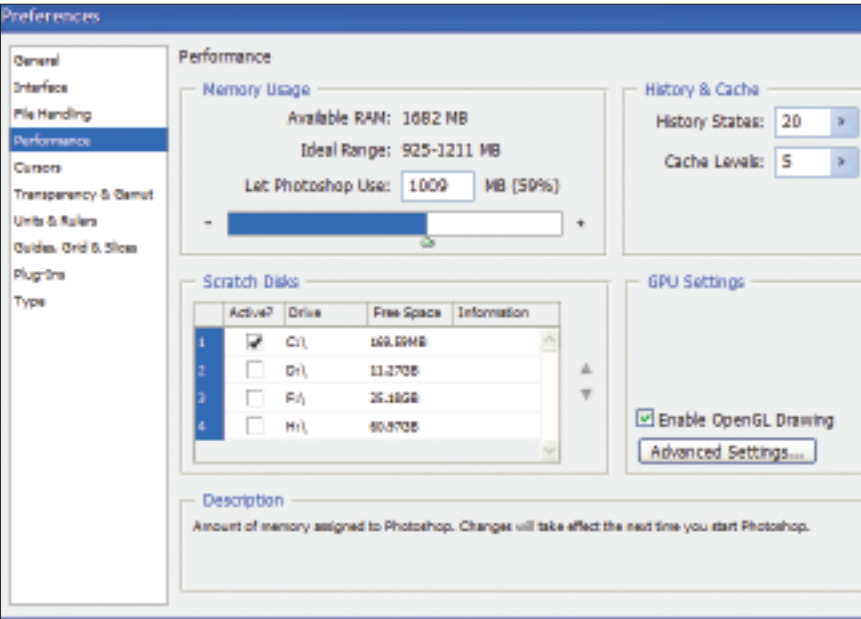
Snapshots save the current state of your image. They are very useful for reverting to a previous state, and are more reliable than the undo tool. You can save multiple snapshots for comparing two different approaches to a photo-editing problem. To create a snapshot, first display the History panel. Go to Window > History. In the History panel menu, select New Snapshot. Enter a name for the snapshot. You can now choose to store the entire image (which is the norm), a version of the image with all the layers flattened, or just the layer

Using Layer Comps

Layer Comps, or layer compositions can be used to show different permutations and combinations from a single PSD file. This can be useful when you have to show a someone a different version of what is essentially the same project. Elements such as logos, names and a few layers may be the same, whereas others like the background or text effects may be different. A layer comp is a configuration of visible layers that can be saved with the file itself. Go to Window > Layer Comp. First select the layers you want to display by clicking on the visibility icon next to the layer. Once a number of layers are selected, go to the Layer Comp panel menu, and select New Layer Comp. To make another Layer Comp, select a different set of visible layers, and select New Layer Comp. You can select and edit a Layer Comp. Layer Comps are stored with the file and can be mailed to clients.

The new blend modes in CS4

CS4 introduces some new blend modes. You need at least two layers in an image to use the blend modes. Go to Layer > Duplicate Layer to create a new layer, or use another image to create a layer. Then go to Layer > Layer Style > Blending Options > Blend Mode and select an option from the drop down menu. The Darker Color mode blends the two layers by displaying the darker of two possible colours. This layer will make no differ-



Performance options in Photoshop